

THE BRASS AUTOMATON

A Steampunk Cocktail Bar with Robotic Bartenders and Live Music

Business Plan | June 2026 | Confidential

THE GAP IN LONDON'S NIGHTLIFE

The Problem

London's cocktail bars are starting to look the same. Dark interiors, exposed brick, the same playlist. The average cocktail costs £13 and rising.

Consumers want experiences. Themed bars (Mr Fogg's, Cahoots) consistently outperform standard venues. But none of them use technology as part of the show.

Robotic bartender tech has matured. \$1.8B market globally. 72% growth in installations. But it's stuck in cruise ships and airports. Nobody has brought it to London's independent bar scene.

The Numbers

£587M UK cocktail market value

£13 Average London cocktail price (rising 51p/year)

\$1.8B Global robotic bartender market (2025)

\$5.6B Projected by 2034 (13.5% CAGR)

0 Robotic bars in London's independent scene

THE CONCEPT

Four elements. One venue. Nothing else like it in London.

1. STEAMPUNK DESIGN

Victorian-industrial interior. Brass, copper, Edison bulbs, gears, vintage instruments. Staff in period costume.

2. ROBOTIC BARTENDERS

Two robotic cocktail units in custom brass casings. Every drink is a performance. 60-90 seconds per cocktail.

3. LIVE MUSIC

Jazz, swing, acoustic. Thursday to Saturday. No cover charge. Fits the era.

4. TAPAS AND COCKTAILS

50+ drinks across 11 categories. Small plates menu. Unlimited drink package ("The Boiler Room").

At a Glance

Location

Shoreditch, East London

Capacity

100 to 130 guests

Size

2,000 to 2,500 sq ft

Opening Hours

Tue-Thu 5pm-12am, Fri-Sat 5pm-2am

Pricing

Signatures £11-13, Classics £8-10

Below London average of £13

THE MENU

DRINKS

- 8 Signature Cocktails (£11-£13)
- 8 Classic Cocktails (£8-£10)
- 9 Martinis & Negronis (£9-£11)
- 4 Vermouths on Rocks (£6-£7)
- 4 Premium Shelf (£15-£17)
- 4 Fancy Shots (£5-£7)
- 7 Simple Shots (£4-£5)
- 5 Beers & Ciders (£5.50-£6.50)
- 5 Wines (£7-£14)
- 7 Mocktails (£5-£6)
- 3 Soft Drinks (£3-£4)

TAPAS (£5-£13)

- Charcuterie Board (for 2) £13
- Mini Wagyu Sliders (x3) £9
- Tempura King Prawns (x4) £8
- Arancini, mushroom & truffle £7
- Pulled Pork Croquettes £7
- Copper Pot Fries £6
- Halloumi Fries £6
- Patatas Bravas £5
- Churros & Chocolate £6

3-4 plates recommended per person

THE BOILER ROOM

Unlimited Drink Package

2 hours from £39/person

3 hours from £52/person

Fri-Sat +£5 premium

INCLUDED

5 selected cocktails, 2 beers,
2 wines, soft drinks

NOT INCLUDED

Other signatures, Premium Shelf,
Martinis, Negronis, vermouths,
Prosecco, Champagne, shots

68-74% gross margin on package

THE TECHNOLOGY

Robotic Bartenders

2 robotic cocktail units (Makr Shagr or equivalent)

Custom steampunk casing (brass, copper, glass panels)

60-90 seconds per cocktail with mechanical choreography

Handles all cocktail prep. Human staff handle hospitality.

Phase 2 (Month 13+)

Robotic drink delivery units for table service

£10,000-£15,000 per unit. Novelty, not replacement.

Investment

£30,000-£40,000

per robotic unit

£5,000-£8,000

per custom steampunk casing

£3,000/year

maintenance per unit

£80,000 total

for 2 units fully installed

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

The audience is already there.

Shoreditch has London's highest concentration of independent bars. The area draws 25-40 year old professionals, tourists, and creatives who actively seek distinctive venues.

Themed and immersive bars consistently outperform standard venues on bookings, repeat visits, and social media engagement.

At steady state, The Brass Automaton needs 85 covers per night. That is roughly 70% of capacity. In a borough with thousands of people looking for somewhere interesting to go on any given evening, 85 is a small target.

The opportunity is not about volume. It is about being memorable enough that the right 85 people choose this bar on any given night.

Target Customer

Age 25-40

Young professionals with disposable income

Experience seekers

People who choose venues for the story, not just the drink

Social media active

Likely to share robot cocktail videos organically

Group bookers

Birthday groups, work socials drawn by The Boiler Room

Tourists

Looking for "only in London" experiences

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Competitor	Type	Cocktail Price	Robots?	Live Music?	Theme?
Mr Fogg's	Themed cocktail bar	£14-£18	No	No	Victorian adventure
Cahoots	Themed cocktail bar	£12-£16	No	Occasional	1940s tube station
The Bletchley	Themed cocktail bar	£13-£17	No	No	WWII code-breaking
Hokus Pokus	Underground bar	£12-£15	No	No	Apothecary/steampunk
Spirit of Man	Steampunk bar	£13-£16	No	No	War of the Worlds
Nightjar	Jazz cocktail bar	£14-£18	No	Yes	Speakeasy
Kansas Smitty's	Jazz bar	£10-£14	No	Yes	Minimal
The Brass Automaton	Steampunk robot bar	£8-£13	YES	YES	Steampunk

No competitor combines robotic bartenders, live music, immersive theming, and below-average pricing. The Brass Automaton occupies a unique position.

FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Revenue	£525,000	£770,000	£977,500
COGS (26.4%)	£138,600	£203,280	£258,060
Gross Profit	£386,400	£566,720	£719,440
Operating Costs	£456,600	£475,000	£495,000
Net Profit (Loss)	(£106,200)	£54,640	£186,250
Avg Daily Covers	50	70	85

Year 1 loss is planned. New bars take 6-9 months to build audience. Monthly profitability by Month 7-8. Year 2 turns positive. Year 3 shows strong returns.

Key Metrics

£42

average spend per cover

26.4%

blended COGS rate

Month 7-8

monthly break-even

59

covers/day to break even

STARTUP INVESTMENT

Item	Cost
Lease Deposit and Legal	£35,000
Steampunk Interior Fitout	£120,000
Robotic Bartender Units (x2)	£80,000
Bar Equipment, POS, Kitchen	£35,000
Initial Stock	£12,000
Licensing, Insurance, PRS/PPL	£6,000
Marketing Launch	£12,000
Working Capital (3 months)	£20,000
TOTAL	£346,000

How the money works

37.5% Fitout

The steampunk interior is the brand. This is not an area to cut.

25% Robotics

Two units fully installed with custom brass casings.

10.9% Equipment

Bar, kitchen, POS, glassware, furniture.

10.9% Lease and Legal

Deposit, solicitor, lease negotiation.

15.7% Stock, Licensing, Marketing, Working Capital

Everything else needed to open the doors.

KEY RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Robot malfunction	Medium	High	Service contract, manual backup, 2 units for redundancy
Slow initial footfall	Medium	High	6-9 month ramp budgeted, marketing spend adjustable
Novelty wear-off	Medium	Medium	Rotate menu quarterly, seasonal themes, varied live acts
Rising rent	Medium	Medium	3-5 year lease with capped increases
Competition copies concept	Low	Medium	First-mover advantage, high barrier to entry (fitout + robots)
Licensing refusal	Low	High	Licensing solicitor engaged early, standard for Shoreditch

LAUNCH PLAN

PHASE 1

Months 1-4: Setup

- Register limited company
- Secure venue lease
- Begin steampunk fitout
- Order and install robots
- Apply for all licences
- Hire GM and bar supervisor
- Build social media presence

PHASE 2

Months 5-6: Soft Launch

- Complete fitout
- Hire remaining staff
- 2-4 week soft launch
- Press and influencer events
- Test robots under real load
- Refine menu from feedback
- Iron out operations

PHASE 3

Months 7-12: Growth

- Grand opening
- Full marketing push
- Launch The Boiler Room
- Start live music programme
- Build reviews and reach
- Target 70 covers/day by M10
- Expansion decision at M18

THE BRASS AUTOMATON

Where Victorian craft meets robotic precision.

£346,000 startup | Break-even Month 7-8 | £224K Year 3 profit

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